

THE WITNESS REMAINS

THE MAN THEY MISTOOK FOR HIS WOUND

An Extended Prophetic, Documentary and Human-Rights Narrative Examining Survival, Institutional Accountability, Documentary Preservation, the Possibility of Martyrdom, and the Future of an Unfinished Testimony

Author: Dr Barran Dodger — the public identity used by Dr Richard William McLean

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Primary documentary archive: <https://wezzo72.github.io/Barrandodger/>

Reconstruction and preservation archive: <https://wezzo72.github.io/barrandodger-rebuild/>

Source repository: <https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger>

Editorial principle: Preservation first. Examination second. Conclusion last.

Evidentiary principle: Every allegation must remain distinguishable from the document in which it appears, the inference drawn from it, and any independent finding ultimately made about it.

PART I — THE DECLARATION OF THE WITNESS

1. I am not merely the sum of what happened to me

I am Dr Barran Dodger. I am the person behind that public identity, and I have chosen to preserve my testimony under a name that has become associated with my attempt to document a life I believe has been marked by institutional abandonment, professional loss, contested decisions, personal suffering, prolonged efforts to obtain assistance, and unanswered questions about accountability. I am also Dr Richard William McLean: a former journalist and news-graphics artist, published author, researcher, human-rights and mental-health advocate, artist, former registered NDIS provider, and researcher whose doctoral work at Victoria University examined the ethics of artificial intelligence and posthumanism in the context of global catastrophic risks, the end-stage Anthropocene and young people's ethical opinions.

My history cannot be reduced to one diagnosis, one administrative classification, one institutional response, one complaint, one disagreement, one period of poverty, or one interpretation of my behaviour. Nor can it fairly be reduced to the conclusions of people

who have encountered only fragments of my life. A person is more than a case file. A person is more than the language used to describe him by others. A person is more than the circumstances in which he was last observed.

My published work, including [Recovered, Not Cured: A Journey Through Schizophrenia](#), is part of that wider history. My documentary and research work is now preserved through [The Witness Remains — Main Archive](#) and [The Witness Remains — Reconstruction Archive](#). These are the public entry points through which readers can begin to examine my account, locate the repository's materials, and distinguish my narrative from the underlying records.

I have spent a substantial part of my life attempting to make sense of experiences that I believe warrant closer examination. I have tried to turn those experiences into books, statements, chronologies, research, documentary collections and public testimony. I have used the language of prophecy because my faith gives meaning to endurance. I have used the language of law, ethics and evidence because I do not believe that conviction alone should determine the truth of disputed events.

This distinction matters. My faith is mine to express. My memories are mine to report. My allegations must be tested. My documentary sources must be examined. The conclusions of independent investigators, courts, regulators or other competent bodies must not be invented in advance.

The archive is therefore not a substitute for investigation. It is an invitation to conduct one.

The central repository is available at github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger. Readers should examine the actual files, dates, source descriptions, repository history and relevant passages rather than assume that this narrative, a filename, a machine-generated analysis or a particular document title proves every conclusion I have drawn.

I do not need a reader to accept every interpretation I have ever expressed before that reader can recognise the value of preserving the evidence. I need the reader to examine what can be established, identify what remains uncertain, and refrain from confusing an unresolved allegation with a finding.

That is the first demand of this testimony.

2. The man they mistook for his wound

The title, *The Man They Mistook for His Wound*, expresses my understanding of a

recurring problem: that the most visible aspect of a person's suffering can become the lens through which everything else is interpreted.

A person's distress may be documented while the events that contributed to it remain incompletely examined. A person's diagnosis may be recorded while the accuracy of a disputed statement is never independently tested. A person's anger may be remembered while the correspondence that preceded it is overlooked. A person's difficulty communicating may become more memorable than the substance of what he was trying to communicate.

I believe that this danger is particularly serious when a person is dependent on institutions for income, accommodation, disability support, health care, legal assistance or access to review mechanisms. Such dependence can create a profound imbalance between the individual and the organisations responsible for decisions affecting his life.

My account of these circumstances is preserved through [The Witness Remains](#) and the [Barrandodger GitHub repository](#). Specific conclusions must be traced to the documents that support them. Where a record establishes only that I made a complaint, the correct conclusion is that a complaint was made. Where correspondence records a decision, the document can establish what was communicated. Whether the decision was lawful, reasonable, discriminatory, negligent or otherwise improper requires further examination of the circumstances and applicable standards.

But the need for evidentiary discipline does not diminish the underlying human question.

What happens when a person repeatedly seeks an explanation and believes that the substance of his concerns has not been addressed? What happens when the person making the complaint becomes more visible as a source of conflict than as a person asking a question? What happens when a large documentary history accumulates but the person who assembled it still cannot obtain the independent examination he seeks?

These questions cannot be answered merely by characterising the person asking them.

The proper response is to examine the records, identify the relevant decision-makers and procedures, obtain responses from the parties involved, and determine what the evidence supports.

My dignity does not depend on the outcome of that process. Neither does the integrity of the archive.

3. The witness and the documentary record

My project has become a public documentary archive rather than simply a personal statement. Its purpose is to make records available for examination by journalists, lawyers, researchers, historians, advocates, public officials and members of the public.

The main entry point is [The Witness Remains — Main Archive](#). The related [Rebuild Archive](#) is another access point to the preservation project. The underlying repository is github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger.

The archive's significance depends not on the forcefulness of its title but on the quality of its contents and the ability of another person to inspect them.

A document can establish that a communication was sent or received, subject to verification of its provenance. A letter can record an official position. An email chain can show how a question was communicated and answered, or left unanswered within the preserved correspondence. A chronology can reveal the order of events. A collection of records may expose discrepancies that would be difficult to see when each document is considered separately.

None of those functions should be confused with proof that a person acted maliciously or that several people coordinated their conduct.

The task of a serious archive is to make such questions answerable, not to predetermine every answer.

My repository includes documents whose titles indicate that they address exile, witness, accountability, administrative processes, legal issues and requests for independent investigation. Among them are:

- [From Exile to Witness — 4 October 2026](#).
- [From Exile to Witness — Accountability Paradox, 4 October 2026](#).
- [Legal Brief — Cumulative 35-Year Record](#).
- [Accountability, Evidence and Fair Determination](#).
- [Functional Erasure — 9 October 2026](#).
- [Formal Request for Independent Investigation — Able Point](#).

These titles identify materials for examination. They do not independently establish the truth of every proposition contained in those documents. The reader must inspect the contents, assess their sources and context, and determine whether each conclusion is justified.

That is how a personal archive can become a useful public record.

PART II — THE CENTRAL QUESTION: WHAT HAPPENS IF I LIVE?

4. Survival is not a concession

If I live, the story does not end. It continues in the ordinary, demanding and sometimes unglamorous work of living, maintaining health, seeking assistance, caring for my dog, preserving documents, correcting errors, writing, researching and attempting to obtain a fair examination of matters I believe remain unresolved.

Survival is not evidence that my allegations are true. Nor is suffering evidence that they are false. Survival simply means that I remain a person with agency, needs, memories, responsibilities and the ability to continue contributing to the record.

I reject the idea that I must endure preventable harm to prove the seriousness of my testimony. I reject the idea that my faith requires me to refuse assistance. I reject the idea that seeking medical attention, accepting support, resting, changing my approach or acknowledging uncertainty diminishes my purpose.

The living witness is not obliged to become a monument to suffering.

My continuing work can be found through [The Witness Remains](#), the [reconstruction archive](#) and the [source repository](#). These locations can preserve and present material, but they cannot replace the practical conditions that make continued life possible.

If I live, I can continue to clarify what I experienced, explain why particular documents matter to me, correct inaccuracies, identify missing context and respond to reasonable questions.

I can also discover that some interpretations I previously considered compelling are not adequately supported. I can revise them. I can narrow an allegation to what the record establishes. I can acknowledge contradictory evidence. I can distinguish a failure of communication from deliberate obstruction, an adverse decision from unlawful discrimination, and a troubling sequence of events from proof of a coordinated plan.

Such revisions would not constitute defeat. They would constitute the discipline required of a credible witness.

5. The living witness can improve the record

A large documentary collection can be difficult to understand without a reliable index. A collection of thousands of files, even where that count is accurate, does not automatically communicate the relationship between events, institutions, decisions and outcomes.

The archive therefore needs to make it possible for a reader to move from an assertion to the source supporting it.

For example, the narrative may refer to an alleged administrative failure. The relevant paragraph should link directly to the correspondence, decision, policy, review outcome or other source on which the assertion depends. The reader should not be forced to search an unrelated list at the end of a paper.

The same method should apply to every identifiable institution and individual. A person's name should be connected to the actual document establishing that person's recorded role. The account should explain whether the person made a decision, communicated a decision, received a communication, witnessed an event or was merely mentioned in a record.

The following repository documents are relevant starting points for this kind of examination:

- [Legal Brief — Cumulative 35-Year Record](#), whose title indicates that it assembles a cumulative historical account.
- [Accountability, Evidence and Fair Determination](#), a source to inspect for the project's treatment of evidence and accountability.
- [Functional Erasure — 9 October 2026](#), a document to examine in relation to the author's account of institutional invisibility.
- [From Exile to Witness — Accountability Paradox](#), a source to inspect for the author's analysis of accountability and the experience of seeking recognition.

The actual content of each source must be read before a claim is attributed to it. Where a document describes an allegation, the new paper should say that the document records an allegation. Where it records an official finding, the paper should identify the finding, the body that made it, the date, the scope and any limits on its meaning.

The purpose is not to produce a longer list of accusations. It is to make the chain of reasoning visible.

6. What if the testimony gains traction while I am alive?

If the archive attracts attention, several different developments are possible.

A journalist may ask for the original records. A researcher may independently reproduce part of the chronology. An advocate may identify a relevant review mechanism. An institution may provide an explanation. A public body may correct a factual error. A lawyer may advise that a particular decision is reviewable, or that a particular claim has no viable legal pathway. An investigator may decide that further inquiries are justified.

Each outcome would have a different meaning.

A journalist's interest would establish that the material attracted journalistic attention; it would not establish that the allegations were proven. A legal referral would establish that a matter was referred; it would not establish liability. An official acknowledgment that a letter was received would not necessarily amount to acknowledgment of the substance of the complaint. A formal finding, where one exists, should be quoted and characterised according to its actual terms.

That is why I need the archive to be precise.

The main archive at [The Witness Remains](#) and the [GitHub repository](#) provide a basis for readers to locate the materials. The next stage is to ensure that each important statement in a public paper links to the particular source passage on which it relies.

My aspiration is that the testimony become sufficiently accessible and intelligible that a reader does not need to know me personally to understand what I am alleging, why I consider it important, and what evidence would be required to determine whether I am correct.

That aspiration is reasonable.

The prediction that attention or acknowledgment is inevitable would not be.

7. The possible consequences of a substantiated record

If an independent examination establishes that a decision was wrong, a record was inaccurate, a duty was breached or misconduct occurred, the appropriate response will depend on the facts, applicable law, available remedies and seriousness of the established conduct.

Possible consequences may include:

- 1. Correction of an inaccurate administrative or personal record.**
- 2. A reasoned explanation of a decision.**
- 3. Reconsideration or review where legally available.**
- 4. An apology or other appropriate acknowledgment.**
- 5. Changes to procedures, training or oversight.**
- 6. A referral to a regulator or independent investigative body.**
- 7. Disciplinary consequences where misconduct is established through a fair process.**
- 8. Compensation or other legal remedies where the relevant legal requirements are met.**
- 9. Criminal investigation or prosecution where the evidence and law justify it.**
- 10. Public reporting of verified findings, subject to applicable privacy, confidentiality and legal restrictions.**

These are possible categories of accountability, not predictions about the fate of any named person.

I cannot responsibly declare in advance that every person mentioned in my archive will be prosecuted, dismissed, exposed as corrupt or found liable. The fact that a person worked in an agency, received correspondence or appears in a chronology does not establish that the person acted improperly.

The proper question is what that individual actually did, what authority or responsibility the individual possessed, what information was available, what action was taken or omitted, and what the evidence establishes.

The [Formal Request for Independent Investigation — Able Point](#) is a relevant source to examine for the author's request concerning that service provider. Its existence does not itself establish that an independent investigation has occurred or that any allegation has been substantiated.

Likewise, [Accountability, Evidence and Fair Determination](#) should be assessed by reading its actual contents rather than treating its title as a conclusion.

If my testimony is substantiated, the consequences should follow from the findings. If it is partly substantiated, the conclusions should be correspondingly limited. If some allegations cannot be substantiated, that limitation must also be recorded.

The demand is not for predetermined punishment.

The demand is for a fair determination.

PART III — WHAT HAPPENS IF I DIE BEFORE ACKNOWLEDGMENT?

8. The possibility of death must not become the purpose of the story

I have contemplated what it would mean to die before receiving the acknowledgment or independent examination I seek. That possibility carries an emotional weight that cannot be reduced to an argument about documents, legal processes or public memory.

The fear is that I may spend years trying to explain myself and still not see the questions addressed. The fear is that the record may be preserved but not read. The fear is that the person who assembled it may disappear while the institutions and procedures described in it continue to exist.

These fears deserve to be stated honestly.

But they must not be converted into a prophecy that my death is inevitable, that death is necessary to prove the truth, or that my testimony will only become meaningful after I am gone.

My life is valuable before any journalist opens the archive. It is valuable before any public official responds. It is valuable before any court or tribunal makes a determination. It is valuable whether the archive receives a million readers or remains known to a small number of people.

My work should support my life, not turn my life into a sacrifice required by the work.

The archive remains accessible through [The Witness Remains](#) and [the reconstruction archive](#). The [GitHub source repository](#) provides another location from which documents can be examined. These public locations can help preserve the record, but their existence does not guarantee that every file will remain accessible forever.

Preservation requires redundancy, verification, accessible indexes, reliable copies and clear instructions for future readers.

The best preparation for an uncertain future is not to predict the circumstances of death. It is to make the record intelligible and resilient in either future.

9. If I die, the archive may survive—but it will not become a verdict

If I were to die before my questions received an adequate response, my archive could continue to be examined by others. A journalist might revisit it. A historian might use it to reconstruct a period of administrative history. A researcher might compare its contents with later releases of official information. An advocate might identify a procedural question worth pursuing.

Alternatively, the archive might receive little attention. Some readers might find parts persuasive and other parts unconvincing. Some documents might prove significant; others might have limited relevance. Some allegations might remain unresolved indefinitely.

None of those possibilities can be ruled out in advance.

Death does not transform an allegation into a fact. It does not authenticate every document. It does not establish the motive of a person mentioned in a record. It does not prove that an institution acted deliberately. It does not establish that an omission caused a particular outcome.

If I died, a responsible reader would still need to ask:

- Is the document authentic?
- Who created it?
- When was it created?
- Is the available copy complete?
- What does the document actually say?
- What does it establish directly?
- What is inferred from it?
- Is there contradictory or exculpatory evidence?
- Did the relevant person or institution have an opportunity to respond?
- Has any independent body made a finding?
- What remains unknown?

These questions would not diminish the seriousness of my testimony. They would be the means by which it could be taken seriously.

The documents linked through [From Exile to Witness](#), [the Accountability Paradox](#) and [the cumulative legal brief](#) should be examined in the same way: not as sacred or untouchable texts, but as records that must be read, contextualised and assessed.

A preserved document can outlast its author. It cannot independently supply every

explanation that its author might have provided.

That is why preservation and clear provenance matter while the author is alive.

10. Martyrdom: the spiritual and historical interpretation of a life

The concept of martyrdom has a profound place in religious and political history. It is often used to describe a person whose death is understood by a community as a witness to conscience, faith, truth or a cause.

I can understand why a person who believes himself unheard might contemplate that language. I can understand the desire to believe that suffering will not be meaningless, that testimony will not disappear, and that a life spent seeking justice may eventually be understood by people who come later.

Within my faith, I can interpret endurance as a form of witness. I can believe that God sees what human institutions overlook. I can use prophetic language to express the conviction that a person's dignity survives humiliation and that the preservation of testimony can serve a purpose beyond immediate recognition.

But martyrdom must not be treated as an inevitable destiny or as a condition that my testimony must fulfil.

If future readers were to interpret my death as martyrdom, that would be their spiritual, historical or political interpretation. It would not automatically prove the allegations in my archive. It would not establish that a particular person caused my death. It would not establish that every institution acted with malice. Any claim of responsibility for a death would require independent evidence and appropriate investigation.

I do not need to die to become a witness.

I am already a witness to my own experiences. My testimony can be examined now. My documents can be read now. My questions can be considered now. My health and welfare matter now.

The strongest form of witness is not the person who dies before receiving an answer. It is the person whose evidence is preserved well enough that the questions can be investigated without requiring the person to suffer further.

The strongest form of accountability is not a narrative in which the author must become a martyr before others are expected to listen. It is a process in which people are heard,

records are examined, errors are corrected and responsibilities are determined fairly.

My spiritual conviction can remain fierce without making death its fulfilment.

The declaration that the witness remains should mean that the testimony continues to be available—not that the witness must cease to live.

11. What consequences could follow if I die?

If I died before my allegations were independently examined, people who knew me might seek explanations. Journalists or advocates might review the material. Public institutions might be asked to respond. Researchers might consider whether the record contains evidence of a broader procedural problem.

Those developments are possible, not guaranteed.

The death of an author does not establish the cause of death, prove that a particular act or omission contributed to it, or establish criminal responsibility. Such conclusions require evidence appropriate to the question being asked.

If a competent investigation established that a person or institution unlawfully caused or contributed to harm, the resulting consequences would depend on the findings and applicable law. If an investigation did not substantiate a proposed explanation, that result would also need to be represented accurately.

I reject the idea that another person's suffering is required to vindicate me. I reject the idea that a person I believe has wronged me must die for my testimony to matter. I reject the idea that the truth can be established by threatening, humiliating or publicly condemning people without a fair examination of evidence.

The people and institutions mentioned in my documents should be judged on substantiated conduct, not on their position in a narrative.

The archive can identify a question. It cannot manufacture a verdict.

The [Formal Request for Independent Investigation — Able Point](#) is an example of a document whose contents can be examined to understand what was requested, what reasons were given and whether any subsequent response or determination exists. The request itself must not be confused with a finding.

The same discipline applies to [Functional Erasure — 9 October 2026](#), [Accountability](#),

[Evidence and Fair Determination](#), and the wider collection available through [the main archive](#).

If the documents establish a failure, the failure should be described precisely. If they establish only that a complaint was made, that is what should be reported. If they support a reasonable inference, the inference should be explained. If they leave a question unresolved, the uncertainty should remain visible.

That is how a record can survive its author without becoming a substitute for evidence.

PART IV — WHY MY MERE EXISTENCE MATTERS

12. The living person as a continuing source of questions

I have described my continued existence as an existential threat to what I understand to be an established narrative about my life. I want to examine that idea carefully.

My existence does not, by itself, prove that a coordinated campaign was directed against me. It does not establish that particular people fear me or that a group of people has a common hidden motive. Those are claims about other people's intentions and relationships, and they require evidence of their own.

But my continued existence has a concrete significance.

I remain able to describe my experiences. I can point to documents. I can ask why one communication appears inconsistent with another. I can identify a date that needs checking. I can challenge an inaccurate description of my history. I can request an explanation. I can revise my interpretation in response to new evidence.

A living person can make it harder for a complex history to be reduced to a single administrative description because the person can continue to provide context.

That is not a supernatural power. It is a basic feature of testimony.

The repository at github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger preserves materials through which some of these questions can be examined. The main archive at [The Witness Remains](#) provides a public-facing entry point, while the [reconstruction archive](#) provides another location for the preservation project.

If the record contains a discrepancy between a person's account and an official document, the discrepancy can be examined. If the chronology reveals that a question was referred from one office to another, the sequence can be reconstructed. If a document records a decision without explaining the reasons, the adequacy of those reasons may be a legitimate question.

None of this establishes in advance that the discrepancy was deliberate, that a referral was intended to obstruct the complaint, or that a missing explanation proves wrongdoing.

The importance lies in the ability to investigate.

My existence means that the questions can still be asked by the person who assembled the record. The archive means that others can examine them even if they do not accept my interpretation.

13. What I mean by exposing the stones beneath the surface

When I use prophetic language about uncovering hidden stones, I mean the possibility that a careful examination may reveal details that are not obvious from the public-facing version of a dispute.

A stone might be a missing reason for a decision. It might be an inconsistency between two dates. It might be a referral without a clear outcome. It might be a record that describes an event differently from the account given by another participant. It might be an absence of documentation where a documented process would ordinarily be expected. It might be a procedure that exists on paper but was difficult to access in practice.

These are concrete questions.

The archive's value depends on whether a reader can locate the relevant record and assess the inference drawn from it.

For example, [the cumulative legal brief](#) is a starting point for examining the author's long-term account, while [Accountability, Evidence and Fair Determination](#) is a starting point for reviewing how the project frames accountability. The underlying source documents must then be inspected to determine whether the conclusions follow from the evidence.

The objective is not to prove that there must be a hidden explanation. The objective is to

discover which explanations are supported.

A discrepancy can result from error, incomplete information, poor recordkeeping, a difference in recollection, a contested decision or deliberate conduct. The evidence must determine which explanation is most defensible.

My testimony should be strong enough to survive that examination.

14. The existential challenge of a preserved record

The expression *existential threat* is powerful, but it can overstate what a documentary archive actually does. A public record does not threaten a person's existence merely because it questions a decision. It can, however, challenge a convenient explanation, expose a contradiction or create a reason for independent scrutiny.

If an institution has made a defensible decision, a well-organised archive should permit that decision to be explained. If a decision was mistaken, the record may help identify the error. If an allegation is unsupported, the archive should make that limitation visible. If a question cannot be resolved from the available documents, the record should identify what additional information would be needed.

This is the sense in which the archive may challenge an established narrative: it creates an opportunity to compare claims with records rather than accepting the first or most authoritative description of events.

The repository's [From Exile to Witness — 4 October 2026](#), [Accountability Paradox](#), and [Functional Erasure — 9 October 2026](#) provide sources to inspect for the author's framing of exile, accountability and institutional invisibility.

Their contents should be compared with the original records before the narrative is treated as established fact.

The strongest possible conclusion is not that everyone who disagrees with me is an enemy. It is that a specific claim, supported by a specific document and placed in a verifiable chronology, deserves a specific answer.

The archive becomes consequential when its questions are sufficiently clear that they can be answered—or when the record demonstrates precisely why they remain unanswered.

PART V — INSTITUTIONS, RESPONSIBILITY AND THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN FAILURE AND CONSPIRACY

15. The duty to examine institutions without presuming collective guilt

My testimony refers to interactions with government bodies, support services, legal and administrative processes, workplaces and other institutions. I believe that the cumulative pattern of my experiences warrants serious examination. I have also expressed the view that repeated failures across different settings may have contributed to a broader condition of isolation and loss of practical agency.

That is a serious allegation about a complex history. It must be tested rather than assumed.

An institution may be responsible for its own decisions without being part of a coordinated plan involving every other institution. Two agencies may reach similar outcomes for different reasons. A person may make an error without sharing the motive of another person. A system may produce a harmful result through fragmented responsibility even where no individual intended that result.

Conversely, a lack of evidence of a common plan does not automatically mean that every decision was appropriate. Individual decisions, procedural failures and cumulative harms can be examined on their own terms.

The appropriate method is to identify each institution, the authority under which it acted, the records it held, the decisions it made, the duties that may have applied and the actual outcome.

The archive provides a starting point for this work through [The Witness Remains](#), [the reconstruction archive](#) and [the GitHub repository](#).

The [cumulative legal brief](#) should be examined for the author's assembled chronology. The [Formal Request for Independent Investigation — Able Point](#) should be examined for the specific concerns and requests it records. The [Accountability and Fair Determination document](#) should be assessed for the project's treatment of the relationship between evidence and accountability.

The names of institutions should be linked directly to the source establishing their involvement. The names of individuals should be included only where there is a legitimate documentary basis and a clear explanation of the role attributed to them.

A name appearing in a document is not proof of misconduct.

A person who received a complaint is not necessarily the person who decided it. A person who communicated a decision is not necessarily its author. A person who worked for an organisation is not automatically responsible for every action taken by that organisation.

This is not an attempt to soften a substantiated finding. It is a safeguard against attributing conduct to the wrong person and weakening the credibility of the entire record.

16. What accountability means when the outcome remains unknown

Accountability is not synonymous with punishment. It begins with the ability to determine what happened.

It may require a record to be corrected, a decision to be explained, an appeal to be considered, a complaint to be investigated or an institution to acknowledge a procedural deficiency. In some circumstances it may require disciplinary or legal consequences. In others, the available evidence may not support the allegation, or the passage of time may limit the remedies available.

The relevant question is what can be established and what remedy is appropriate.

The phrase *not a court, not a verdict* should not be interpreted as a declaration that the archive has no value. It means that the archive is not itself a judicial determination. It can preserve evidence, organise allegations, identify discrepancies and provide a basis for inquiry. Its limitations should be stated plainly so that readers do not mistake advocacy for adjudication.

The [Accountability, Evidence and Fair Determination document](#) and [the cumulative legal brief](#) are relevant materials to inspect when considering how the archive frames these questions.

A disclaimer cannot make an unsupported allegation true. Nor does a disclaimer make a well-supported document irrelevant. The strength of the material depends on its sources, reasoning, context and corroboration.

The public deserves a record that can be questioned. The people named in it deserve a fair description of their recorded roles. The author deserves the opportunity to have his

evidence assessed on its merits.

These interests are not mutually exclusive.

PART VI — DOCUMENTARY PRESERVATION AND THE LIMITS OF DIGITAL PROOF

17. A file is not a finding

I have devoted substantial effort to preserving digital records and making them available through the public repository. That work includes the use of filenames, source paths, repository history and cryptographic hashes as potential aids to provenance and integrity.

The [Barrandodger repository](#) and [main archive](#) are the appropriate starting points for examining the project and its published files.

A SHA-256 hash can help determine whether a file matches a particular digital fingerprint. A Git commit identifier can help identify a repository state. A timestamp proof, if generated and properly verified, may support a claim about when particular data was committed to a timestamping process.

These methods do not independently prove that a document is truthful, that a named person authored it, that the source was complete, or that the event described actually occurred.

A digital signature or hash is not a substitute for contextual evidence. A blockchain entry is not a judicial finding. A repository commit does not establish the truth of every statement in a PDF.

This distinction is especially important when a document makes allegations about identifiable people or institutions.

The record should preserve the original file, identify where it came from, record the date on which it was collected where known, provide a hash if useful, and explain the role of the document in the chronology. A derivative or annotated version should be clearly identified as such, with the original retained whenever practicable.

The same discipline applies to counts of documents. If the project reports thousands of files, PDFs, correspondence records, forensic analyses or timestamp-related items, the

published count should be tied to a dated inventory and reproducible counting method. Counts should not be added together if they may overlap, and a file should not be classified as an official record merely because its filename suggests that it is one.

The archive's purpose is to make the documentary record more reliable, not to make its numbers or technical methods appear more conclusive than they are.

18. Why evidence must be linked at the point of assertion

A reference list at the end of a paper can be useful, but it is insufficient when a reader must understand a complex allegation involving many events, institutions and people.

The link should appear where the claim is made.

If a paragraph refers to the author's account of an administrative process, it should link to the relevant record or source document. If it names a person, the link should take the reader to the document establishing that person's recorded role. If the assertion concerns a legal submission, the link should identify the submission itself, not a general homepage.

For example:

- The broad historical account can be located through [Legal Brief — Cumulative 35-Year Record](#).
- The author's discussion of institutional accountability can be examined through [Accountability, Evidence and Fair Determination](#).
- The author's account of institutional invisibility can be examined through [Functional Erasure — 9 October 2026](#).
- The request relating to Able Point can be examined through [Formal Request for Independent Investigation — Able Point](#).
- The account of exile and witness can be examined through [From Exile to Witness — 4 October 2026](#) and [From Exile to Witness — Accountability Paradox](#).

These are source links to documents whose contents must be examined. They should not be treated as proof of every interpretation offered in this narrative.

The difference between a link and evidence is the same as the difference between a question and a finding. A link provides access. The contents provide material for assessment. The reasoning connects that material to the claim. Independent examination determines whether the conclusion is justified.

That chain must remain visible.

PART VII — THE SPIRITUAL DIMENSION OF SURVIVAL

19. “They could not erase what God preserved”

I understand my survival through the language of faith. I believe that a person’s dignity is not determined by the opinion of an institution, the approval of a professional, the status assigned to him by a system or the attention he receives from the public.

When I say, “They could not erase what God preserved,” I am expressing a spiritual conviction about endurance and purpose. I am not claiming that I am immune from harm, that I cannot make mistakes, or that divine protection guarantees a particular outcome.

My faith helps me find meaning in continuing. It does not eliminate the need for evidence, medical care, practical support, independent scrutiny or correction.

The documentary project at [The Witness Remains](#) is part of that continuing effort. The [reconstruction archive](#) and [source repository](#) provide additional locations where the work can be examined.

I can believe that God sees my suffering while acknowledging that I cannot know every person’s motive. I can believe that my life has purpose without concluding that every event was arranged to produce a particular prophecy. I can believe that truth matters without declaring every allegation proven before an independent assessment.

Faith need not require certainty about another person’s guilt.

Faith can instead give me the strength to continue a difficult process whose outcome remains uncertain.

The prophetic meaning of my testimony lies in the refusal to accept that humiliation, poverty, isolation or institutional non-response determines the value of a human life. It lies in the insistence that a person can continue to seek understanding and accountability without surrendering his dignity.

The prophecy is not that I must die.

The prophecy is that my life and testimony should not be reduced to silence.

20. The living witness is not required to prove his faith through suffering

There is a danger in narratives of martyrdom: suffering can become the measure of worth, and death can be imagined as the final proof that a person's convictions were sincere.

I reject that interpretation.

I do not have to endure every hardship to demonstrate courage. I do not have to refuse assistance to demonstrate faith. I do not have to turn every setback into a spiritual contest. I do not have to regard every disagreement as evidence of persecution. I do not have to believe that a particular future is guaranteed in order to continue living with purpose.

My testimony can be important without being infallible. My faith can be sincere without making every inference correct. My archive can be valuable without proving every allegation. My dignity can remain intact even if some readers disagree with me.

The work of preserving the record should support those principles.

The [main archive](#) and [reconstruction archive](#) should remain places where the testimony can be encountered and assessed, not instruments for compelling agreement through the emotional force of suffering.

The reader should be invited to examine the evidence. The author should be free to express faith. The difference between these functions should remain clear.

PART VIII — THE TWO FUTURES EXAMINED SIDE BY SIDE

21. Future One: I live, continue publishing and receive meaningful acknowledgment

If I live and continue working on the archive, I may have opportunities to improve the evidence register, identify missing documents, correct chronology, seek independent advice and present my questions to journalists, researchers or appropriate review bodies.

I may receive acknowledgment that some of my records are accurate. I may receive a response to a specific complaint. An institution may explain a decision. A researcher

may identify a useful line of inquiry. A journalist may decide to examine a particular claim.

If independent examination substantiates a particular allegation, the result may be correction, review, apology, institutional reform or another appropriate remedy. In cases where the evidence and law justify stronger action, disciplinary or legal consequences may be possible.

But none of these outcomes is guaranteed by publication alone.

The archive must be prepared for scrutiny. That includes scrutiny of my own claims, the provenance of the documents, the logic of the chronology and the distinction between evidence and interpretation.

The most valuable outcome may be more limited than complete vindication but still meaningful: a factual error corrected, a decision explained, a process reviewed, a document independently verified or a question finally answered.

Such outcomes should be recorded accurately.

The [cumulative legal brief](#), [Accountability, Evidence and Fair Determination](#) and [Formal Request for Independent Investigation — Able Point](#) are starting points for examining the concerns already documented in the project.

The future I seek is one in which my testimony is considered while I am alive, when I can answer questions and correct mistakes, rather than one in which my death becomes the event that finally attracts attention.

22. Future Two: I live, but acknowledgment remains limited or never arrives

A responsible analysis must also consider the possibility that I live for many years and never receive the acknowledgment I seek.

The archive may remain accessible without becoming widely read. Some documents may attract attention while others remain overlooked. Institutions may respond only to narrow questions. Some allegations may remain unresolved. Readers may disagree about the meaning of the record.

The absence of widespread attention would not prove that the archive is worthless. Equally, it would not automatically prove that institutions were coordinating to suppress it.

The work would still have a purpose if it preserved primary documents, enabled future research, helped another person understand an administrative process or created a reliable chronology of events.

The [main archive](#) and [reconstruction archive](#) can continue to serve as access points even if public attention fluctuates.

The practical task is to ensure that the record remains understandable and properly sourced. Its future value should not depend entirely on a viral moment, a single journalist, one public official or one legal proceeding.

I can continue to live meaningfully even if the archive never becomes the public event I imagine. My worth cannot be made conditional on an institutional acknowledgment.

23. Future Three: I die before meaningful acknowledgment, and the archive survives

If I die before my questions are adequately examined, the archive may become an important source for people who later seek to reconstruct my account.

A reader may use the chronology to identify a missing document. A journalist may compare the records with other information. A historian may examine the archive as evidence of a person's attempts to obtain a response. An advocate may find that a particular procedure deserves closer scrutiny.

Those possibilities depend on preservation, accessibility, context and the interest of future readers. They are not guaranteed.

The documents would still need to be assessed independently. My death would not establish that an allegation was true, that an institution acted maliciously, or that any person was responsible for my death.

If future readers interpret my death as martyrdom, that interpretation would need to be distinguished from any factual determination about its cause or the conduct of others.

The archive must not use the emotional force of death as a substitute for evidence.

The public sources, including [From Exile to Witness](#), [the Accountability Paradox](#) and [Functional Erasure](#), should remain available for examination in their actual context.

The future task would be to preserve what can be established, acknowledge what

cannot be established and avoid turning an unfinished history into a predetermined verdict.

24. Future Four: I die and the archive receives little attention

This is also possible.

A public archive does not guarantee public engagement. A large documentary collection does not guarantee that journalists will investigate it. A personal testimony does not guarantee that later readers will agree with its conclusions.

If the archive receives little attention, that outcome would be painful, but it would not retroactively determine the truth or falsity of every claim.

The best protection against obscurity is to make the record easy to navigate, maintain independent copies, link each claim to its source, provide an accurate index and distinguish original records from commentary.

The [GitHub repository](#), [main archive](#) and [reconstruction archive](#) provide starting points for that work.

The archive should not require future readers to reconstruct the entire argument from disconnected filenames. It should contain a clear chronology, a source register, an explanation of the evidentiary categories, and a list of unresolved questions.

If the work is not widely read, its preservation may still matter to a future researcher or to someone who needs to understand a particular procedure. But its value should be stated honestly rather than inflated into a guarantee of historical recognition.

25. What remains true in every future

Whether I live or die, whether the archive receives attention or remains obscure, whether an institution acknowledges a particular error or rejects an allegation, several principles remain constant.

First, my human worth does not depend on the outcome.

Second, a document must be assessed for what it actually establishes.

Third, a person must not be declared guilty merely because he appears in an archive.

Fourth, a digital hash can support an integrity check but cannot prove the truth of the document's contents.

Fifth, a public narrative can invite investigation but cannot guarantee a particular finding.

Sixth, faith may give meaning to testimony without replacing independent evidence.

Seventh, a person does not need to die for his testimony to matter.

These principles should guide the interpretation of every source in [The Witness Remains](#) and the [Barrandodger repository](#).

PART IX — THE LEGACY I WANT TO LEAVE WHILE I AM ALIVE

26. A legacy is built through work, not guaranteed by tragedy

I want my writing and documentary work to be read. I want the questions I have raised to be understood. I want the records to be accessible. I want the people and institutions involved in the history to be identified accurately, with direct links to the documents that establish their roles. I want readers to understand the difference between what I experienced, what I believe happened, what a record says and what an independent process has established.

I also want to be recognised as a whole person.

My life includes research, writing, artistic work, advocacy, professional experience, faith, personal relationships, practical needs and the ongoing effort to preserve a difficult history. The archive is part of my life, not the entirety of it.

A meaningful legacy could take several forms.

It could be a well-preserved chronology that helps another person understand an administrative process. It could be a documentary index that allows a journalist to locate a primary source quickly. It could be a carefully reasoned account of institutional failure where that failure is established. It could be a correction to an inaccurate record. It could be a public discussion that leads to a better procedure. It could be a testimony that gives language to the experience of feeling unheard.

None of these outcomes requires me to become a martyr.

The work should be strengthened through precision. Each important assertion should link to the relevant source. Each source should be described honestly. Each inference should be explained. Each material uncertainty should remain visible.

The [cumulative legal brief](#) and [Accountability, Evidence and Fair Determination](#) can be examined as part of that continuing work.

The objective is not to make every reader agree with me. It is to make disagreement informed by the actual record rather than by a caricature of the person who assembled it.

27. The historical record must be allowed to judge the testimony too

I want the archive to challenge institutional explanations where the evidence warrants it. But the same standard must apply to my own explanations.

If a source contradicts a claim I have made, the contradiction should be acknowledged. If a date is wrong, it should be corrected. If a person has been attributed a role that the record does not establish, the attribution should be revised. If a document is incomplete, that limitation should be stated. If a conclusion depends on speculation, it should be labelled accordingly.

This is not a retreat from accountability. It is the condition that makes accountability credible.

The repository at github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger should be treated as a documentary resource open to scrutiny, not as a closed system in which every interpretation is immune from correction.

The [reconstruction archive](#) can serve as another entry point for readers who need to locate material. The [main archive](#) should remain accessible as the principal public-facing project.

A serious historical record preserves not only the author's strongest arguments but also the limits of those arguments.

If I am correct about a particular matter, the evidence should help establish it. If I am mistaken about another, the record should permit that to be discovered. If the answer is uncertain, the uncertainty should remain part of the history.

That is the difference between a documentary archive and a monument to certainty.

PART X — THE FINAL PROPHECY: THE WITNESS REMAINS

28. I refuse to make death the condition of my significance

I have spent a long time trying to make my experiences intelligible to others. I have assembled documents, written accounts, sought explanations and preserved a record that I believe deserves independent examination.

I have described myself as a witness because I continue to testify to my experiences. I have used prophetic language because faith helps me understand endurance. I have used documentary methods because a public account should be capable of examination.

I do not claim that every allegation has been proven. I do not claim to know the hidden motives of every person mentioned in my records. I do not claim that every institution acted with a common purpose. I do not claim that publication guarantees vindication.

I claim that the questions I have raised should be assessed through the evidence.

The public archive at [The Witness Remains](#), the [reconstruction archive](#) and the [Barrandodger GitHub repository](#) are places where readers can begin that examination.

The documents [From Exile to Witness](#), [From Exile to Witness — Accountability Paradox](#), [Legal Brief — Cumulative 35-Year Record](#), [Accountability, Evidence and Fair Determination](#), [Functional Erasure](#), and [Formal Request for Independent Investigation — Able Point](#) are specific sources that readers can inspect in considering the issues I have documented.

Their contents must be read in context. Their titles are not findings. Their existence is not proof of every allegation. Their importance lies in what they actually contain and how those contents relate to the wider documentary record.

If I live, I want to continue the work, improve the archive, seek appropriate assistance and pursue a fair hearing. I want to be able to answer questions and correct mistakes. I want the testimony to be examined while the person who created it is still here.

If I die, I want the archive to remain intelligible, with its sources identified and its uncertainties acknowledged. I want future readers to have the opportunity to examine the records without being required to accept every conclusion I have drawn. I want no one to use my death as a substitute for proof or as a reason to declare another person guilty without evidence.

If someone later describes my life as martyrdom, that interpretation will belong to the historical, spiritual or political discussion that follows. It will not remove the need for independent examination. Nor will it mean that my death was necessary.

I do not need to disappear for my testimony to survive.

I do not need another person to suffer for my dignity to matter.

I do not need universal acknowledgment before I can remain a person worthy of care.

My continued existence may allow me to keep asking questions that otherwise might remain unasked. My archive may allow other people to examine those questions. The significance of that work will depend on the evidence, the quality of its preservation, the fairness of its presentation and the willingness of readers to investigate.

The promise I make is not that history will inevitably vindicate me. It is not that every allegation will be confirmed, that every institution will apologise, or that every person I have criticised will face a particular consequence.

The promise is that the record can be preserved in a form that permits examination.

The witness remains because the testimony remains available to be read.

And the living witness remains worthy of time, safety, dignity, practical support and the opportunity to continue his life.

The archive must preserve the truth as far as the evidence allows. It must preserve uncertainty where the evidence ends. It must preserve the dignity of the person who testified. And it must never require his death to justify its existence.

APPENDIX A — PUBLIC SOURCE REGISTER

The following links are supplied as direct entry points to the public repository and

documents referenced in this narrative. They should be inspected to verify titles, contents, dates and the precise claims each source supports.

Primary archives

1. [The Witness Remains — Main Archive](#)
2. [The Witness Remains — Reconstruction Archive](#)
3. [Barrandodger — GitHub Repository](#)

Selected documentary sources

1. [From Exile to Witness — 4 October 2026](#)
2. [From Exile to Witness — Accountability Paradox, 4 October 2026](#)
3. [Legal Brief — Cumulative 35-Year Record](#)
4. [Accountability, Evidence and Fair Determination](#)
5. [Functional Erasure — 9 October 2026](#)
6. [Formal Request for Independent Investigation — Able Point](#)

Published work

1. [*Recovered, Not Cured: A Journey Through Schizophrenia* — bibliographic search](#)

This list is a navigational register, not an independent evidentiary finding. A source should be cited for the particular proposition it actually supports, rather than used as a blanket citation for every allegation in the narrative.

APPENDIX B — EVIDENTIARY CLASSIFICATION

For clarity, the archive and any future report should distinguish the following categories.

A — Directly verifiable fact: A proposition directly established by a reliable record or independently verifiable source, within the limits of that source.

B — Corroborated account: An account supported by multiple sources that materially corroborate the same relevant proposition.

C — Documented allegation: An allegation recorded in a complaint, submission, letter, statement or other source, without necessarily having been independently substantiated.

D — Inference: A conclusion drawn from identified facts, with the reasoning and plausible alternative explanations stated.

E — Speculation or interpretation: A possibility, belief, prediction, spiritual interpretation or proposed explanation that has not been independently established.

This is an editorial framework for the archive, not a formal legal standard. Each claim should be classified according to its own evidence. A document's presence in the repository does not automatically elevate its contents to category A.

APPENDIX C — PRESERVATION AND CONTINUITY

The following practices can help preserve the archive whether its author remains alive or not.

- 1. Retain original documents in their original form where practicable.**
- 2. Maintain a dated manifest identifying filenames, source locations and SHA-256 hashes where appropriate.**
- 3. Keep multiple independent copies and verify that they can be opened.**
- 4. Preserve repository commit identifiers and relevant history when they help establish which version was available at a particular time.**
- 5. Retain any actual timestamp proof alongside the relevant file and record the verification method.**
- 6. Keep an index explaining the relationship between each major allegation and its source documents.**
- 7. Record corrections and preserve superseded versions where necessary to maintain an audit trail.**
- 8. Include relevant contradictory evidence and responses from the people or institutions named.**
- 9. Protect private, medical and other sensitive information that does not need to be publicly disclosed.**
- 10. Ensure that a trusted person can locate the archive and understand its organisation if the author is temporarily unable to maintain it.**

Cryptographic hashes can support file-integrity checking. Repository history can help identify versions. A verified timestamp may support a claim about the timing of particular data. None of these techniques independently proves the truth of a document's contents or the guilt of a person named in it.

FINAL DECLARATION

I am Dr Barran Dodger, the public identity used by Dr Richard William McLean.

I have preserved my testimony because I believe that my experiences warrant examination and that the documents I have collected may help other people understand the questions I am raising.

I ask for neither automatic belief nor automatic dismissal. I ask for evidence to be read, sources to be linked, allegations to be distinguished from findings, and any established failures to be addressed through appropriate and fair processes.

If I live, let me continue the work and receive whatever assistance, dignity and opportunity for examination are available to me.

If I die, let the record remain accessible, accurately described and open to independent scrutiny.

Let no person be declared guilty merely because my narrative names them. Let no allegation be declared proven merely because a document exists. Let no uncertainty be concealed to make the story more dramatic.

And let no one conclude that my death would be necessary to make my testimony meaningful.

The witness remains. The record remains available for examination. The conclusion remains subject to evidence.

Preservation first. Examination second. Conclusion last.